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Senior Service Designer

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Wednesday 1st July 2026



Government
Digital Service

Reference number

466394

Salary

£63,240 - £74,317

£70,834 - £74,317 (London) / £63,240 - £66,610 (National) Based on capability. The base salary of this grade is £61,620 for London and £56,850 for other locations. Offers made above this will be made up with a specialist pay allowance.

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Fixed term

Length of employment

2 Years

Business area

GDS - Digital Centre Design

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

1

Contents

[Location](#)

[About the job](#)

[Benefits](#)

[Things you need to know](#)

[Apply and further information](#)

Location

Bristol, London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and at the forefront of coordinating the UK's geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We're part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you'll be working with some of the world's most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation's highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

Job description

GDS Local is a specialist unit within the Service Transformation Directorate, working at the point where central government platforms, local services and sector reform meet. We help councils and government partners create the conditions for better, more joined-up public services by unlocking usable data, accelerating adoption of common components, shaping a more open technology market and building stronger routes for collaboration.

Our work is focused on four connected objectives:

1. Creating a shared vision for local government technology, data and the market so councils can make better digital and procurement decisions
2. Unlocking usable, shareable data so councils and delivery partners can support people earlier, faster and more effectively
3. Making it easier to adopt common products and platforms such as GOV.UK App and One Login, while reducing the risk and cost of reuse
4. Building the conditions for collaboration across councils, sector bodies and central government so change can scale across the whole system

Our mission is ambitious and practical: to help make public services simpler, more responsive and more connected for local authority residents, especially those with complex needs. By improving how councils buy technology, share data, adopt trusted platforms and work with government, we are helping create easier lives for residents, better value for money across local government and greater public trust in digital services.

You will design end-to-end service journeys that cut across organisational boundaries and channels. In GDS Local, that means shaping how national platforms, local service delivery and market conditions combine into services that work in practice for residents and practitioners, and how GDS Local delivers for our users.

As a Senior Service Designer you'll:

lead service design work for GDS Local, designing how our offer delivers for GDS and local authority users across one or more priority initiatives (products adoption, market reform, or data innovation)

map end to end journeys, service blueprints and ecosystems, identifying friction, duplication and opportunities for reuse

facilitate multidisciplinary teams, working with policy, technology, data, commercial and delivery colleagues, helping teams make clear, testable design decisions

work with user research and analytics to translate insight into service improvements and strategic recommendations

develop artefacts and narratives that support decision making by senior stakeholders across central and local government

support the team to embed good practice and inclusive, accessible design

Person specification

We're interested in people who can demonstrate:

experience designing, supporting other designers, and improving end-to-end services across multiple organisations or complex stakeholder environments

strong practice in delivering whole-of service design, including service mapping, identifying and creating new design patterns and components, highlighting pain points and opportunities for improvement

significant ability to use qualitative and quantitative data to develop and test design ideas, inform decisions and improve services across the product lifecycle from discovery to live

ability to clearly communicate complex design concepts and decisions to senior stakeholders and non-design audiences

experience facilitating workshops and co design with practitioners, including in politically sensitive or high scrutiny contexts, and the ability to adapt design sessions to ensure you align diverse perspectives and drive shared outcomes

experience designing accessible and inclusive services, ensuring your design work meets appropriate accessibility and sustainability standards and advising team members on best practice

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours
- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%
- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days
- an extra day off for the King's birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme
- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets
- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)
- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at <https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk>

Office attendance

The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from

your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.

DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 750 words and answer 1 application question. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above

a 60 minute video interview. As part of the interview process there will be a presentation task, details around the presentation task will be shared with shortlisted candidates

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

Please describe a time when you designed or improved an end-to-end service across multiple organisations or within a complex stakeholder environment.

In the Civil Service, we use [Success Profiles](#) to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We'll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we'll be assessing you against the following [Civil Service Behaviours](#):

- seeing the big picture
- working together
- managing a quality service
- changing and improving

We'll also be assessing your experience and specialist technical skills against the following skills defined in the Government Digital and Data Capability Framework for the [Senior Service Designer](#) role:

- leading design
- evidence-based design
- designing strategically
- designing together

Want to know more about who Government Digital and Data are? [Click Here](#)

Recruitment Timeline

Virtual recruitment event: Friday 19th June at 12pm - 1pm

Sift completion: Thursday 9th July 2026

Panel interviews: starting from Thursday 16th July 2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and [the Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

Open Recruitment Session

To provide more information and context about GDS Local, we are holding an open recruitment session on the 19th June 2026, from 12:00 - 13:00. There will be a presentation followed by a Q&A Session. If you would like to be invited to the session, please email GDSrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals

- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and
family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status
under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\)](#) (opens in a new
window)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and
family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application
for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement
Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who
were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who
have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements](#) (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code](#) (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of
behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in
the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles](#) (opens in a new
window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As
such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with
disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever
it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) (opens in a
new window) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy](#) (opens in
a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

